

ICT and Business Writing

Science

May, 2026

Short Title: ICT and Business Writing
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster IT
Author ECLAFFEY
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

In this module the student will learn how to write various types of professional business and field reports, prepare presentations for small and large audiences using various computer programs, and be given detailed assistance on how to optimise their presentation before an audience.

Programmes

ECTS-0001 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

3 / 5 / M

Indicative Content

- Different types of business and field reports
- Structure of business reports
- Structure of field reports
- Grammar and punctuation
- Computer programs, e.g. MS PowerPoint, MS Excel
- Graphics, tables, charts
- Databases
- Referencing
- Plagiarism
- Presentations to audiences

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Compose various types of professional business and field reports.
2. Prepare business and field reports using various computer programs.
3. Complete professional presentations to small and large audiences, using appropriate software.
4. Operate in a team to produce a poster presentation.
5. Use the Internet and online library resources to produce an academic report on a relevant topic in the Irish agricultural and agri-business sector.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Tutorials, including use of ICT laboratory.
- Presentations before various audiences.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Assignment	30%	1,2,3
Assignment	40%	2,5
Group Project	30%	3,4

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** The student will show inadequate knowledge and understanding of the subject matter and be unable to write business and field reports. Failure to prepare and/or present an adequate project report.
- 40%-49%:** Will be able to show a basic knowledge of the key learning outcomes including how to write business and field reports and how to prepare and present a project report.
- 50%-59%:** As well as the above, the student will be able to write professional business and field reports and prepare and present a project report.
- 60%-69%:** The student will be able to write a very good business and field reports of the project and give a very good presentation of the project report.
- 70%-100%:** The learner will be able to write excellent business and field reports and give an excellent presentation of the project report.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	30	
Tutorial	6	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Bowden, J. *Writing a Report: How to Prepare, Write and Present Effective Reports*. 9th ed. USA: Boffin Books, 2011.
- Forsyth, P. *How to Write Reports and Proposals*. 3rd ed. USA: Kogan Page Publishers, 2013.
- Hanson, P., C. Quinn and R. Jarman. "The Media Conference Project: Developing students' listening, talking, reading and writing skills through their production of science news reports." *School Science Review*. 97, 359. (2015): 46-54.
- Truss, L. *Eats, Shoots & Leaves: The Zero Tolerance Approach to Punctuation*. USA: Profile Books, 2004.

Supplementary Material

- Holdon, G. *Business Reports for Busy People: Timesaving, Ready-to-Use Reports for Any Occasion*. 1st ed.. USA: Career Press, 2011.
- Straus, J., L. Kaufman and T. Stern. *The Blue Book of Grammar and Punctuation: An Easy-to-Use Guide with Clear Rules, Real-World Examples, and Reproducible Quizzes*. 7th ed. US: Jossey-Ball, Wiley, 2014.
- Zinsser, W.K. *On Writing Well: The Classic Guide to Writing Non-Fiction*. UK: Quill Press, 2006.

Requested Resources

- COMPUTER LAB: Networks Lab